

Ros Clayton

PhD Candidate in Economics, Stellenbosch University
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Research Fields

Economics of Education; Development Economics; Applied Microeconometrics

Education

PhD in Economics, Stellenbosch University Expected 2027

Thesis: The Consequences of Grade Repetition in South Africa: Evidence from Early Grades to Secondary School

Supervisors: Dr Gabrielle Wills and Prof. Servaas van der Berg

MPhil Education, University of Cambridge 2015

Awarded with distinction.

BSocSci (Hons) Economics, University of Cape Town 2011

Awarded in the first class.

BSocSci Economics and Mathematics, University of Cape Town 2007–2010

Awarded with distinction.

Working Papers

- **The impact of early grade repetition on test scores: Evidence from a regression discontinuity design in South Africa** (RESEP, Stellenbosch University, 2025)
- **Linguistic interdependence? Foundation Phase mastery in home language as a predictor of Grade 4 repetition and EFAL marks** (RESEP, Stellenbosch University, 2025)
- **From Grade 7 arithmetic to matric: A quantitative evaluation of the Numeric afterschool maths program** (Evaluation report, 2024.)
- **Growing apart: Tracking the pro-girl achievement gap across early grades in South African primary schools** (RESEP, Stellenbosch University, 2026; Co-authored with Dr Gabrielle Wills)

Research Experience

PhD candidate, RESEP, Stellenbosch University 2024–present

- Designed and implemented causal inference studies using RD
- Analysed and cleaned large administrative datasets in R (data.table) and Stata
- Conducted quantile regression and fixed effects models to study educational outcomes

Researcher, Independent consultant 2023–2024

- Designed and implemented evaluation studies, including an RCT follow-up using administrative datasets
- Leveraged LLMs to code qualitative data

Presentations

- **The impact of early grade repetition on test scores: Evidence from a regression discontinuity design in South Africa** (Economic Society of South Africa Centenary Conference (2025))
- **The effect of early-grade repetition on Home Language performance** (Reading Panel, Johannesburg, 2026.)
- **Linguistic interdependence? Foundation Phase mastery in home language as a predictor of Grade 4 repetition and EFAL marks** (RESEP Quantitative Education Conference, University of Stellenbosch (2025))

Policy writing

- **The impact of early grade repetition on learner marks** (RESEP policy brief, 2025.)
- **How home language mastery predicts early learning outcomes** (RESEP policy brief, 2025.)

Teaching Experience

University of Cape Town

Teaching Assistant, Analysis of Household Survey Data (Honours) 2012

Head Tutor, Game Theory 2011

Tutor 2010–2011

- Microeconomics I
- Game Theory
- Microeconomics III

Technical Skills

R, Stata, Python, LaTeX